place prepositions, prepositions in phrases, place adverbs

in, at, on

Use *in* for things enclosed in something else. We use *in* with towns and countries.

Sugar dissolves ***in water.*** *The cell is found* ***in the upper part of the leaf.***
in Ghana ***in Pisa*** ***in the north of Italy***

Use *at* with a place.

Ask ***at the cinema*** *for details.* ***At the point*** *where the two lines meet ...*

Use *on* for things on the surface or side of something, and with islands.

Some lichens grow ***on bare rock.*** *There were no trees* ***on the island.***

We generally use *on* for trains, buses, ships and planes, and *in* for cars.

I met an old friend ***on the train.***

into, out of

Into describes movement in and *out of* is the opposite. In everyday speech, *out* is used instead of *out of*.

Two men came ***into the bank.*** *Everyone ran* ***out of the burning building.***

Out of is also the opposite of *in*.

Mr Smith is ***out of the building*** *at the moment.*

inside, outside

Inside is used to describe something in a room etc, especially when the speaker is outside.

The police were watching what was happening ***inside the bank.***
Can you stand ***outside the door,*** *please.*

to, from

Use *to* with verbs of movement, change etc, though not with *home*.

Not many children ***go to school*** *in Burkina Faso.* ***I went home*** *at 6.00*

Use *to* and *from* to describe the two points of a movement.

It changes ***from a liquid to a solid.***

below, under, beneath

Below means 'at a lower level' and occurs in phrases such as *below zero; below average; see below for more information.*

Under can mean 'covered by', as in *under the bed* and *under a pile of books.*

We also use it in these phrases:

Look it up ***under 'Mammals'.*** *Children* ***under five*** *are admitted free.*

Beneath means 'exactly under' and can be used in place of under.

We sat ***beneath / under a tree.*** ***Beneath / under a pile*** *of books ...*

above, over

Above means at a higher level than something, and not touching it.

Put your hands ***above*** *your head.* *There is a forest* ***above*** *the village.*

Over is the opposite of *under*, and can mean 'touching or covering'.

They put a blanket ***over*** *him to keep him warm.*

Above and *over* can be used to mean the same thing, especially when something is at a higher level exactly vertically.

They lived in a flat ***above / over*** *the bank.*

preposition + noun + *of*

at the end of	*at the side of*	*at the beginning of*	*at the end of*
at the front of	*at the back of*	*at the bottom of*	*at the top of*
in front of	*in the middle of*		

The cinema is ***at the end of*** *the street.*
Two very tall people were sitting ***in front of*** *me.*

prepositions as adverbs

Many prepositions are used as adverbs.

Is Susan ***in****?* (at home) *No, she's* ***out****.* (not at home)
From the mountain, we could see a village far below.

Other examples: ***away*** (on holiday); ***indoors***; ***inside***; ***outside***; ***underneath***.

Peter is ***away*** *at the moment. He's on a trip abroad. In France, actually.*
Let's go ***indoors*** */* ***inside****. It's getting cold* ***outside****.*
If you can't find it ***on top****, look* ***underneath****.*

1 Underline the correct option.

a More than a thousand people came *at* / *to* the match.
b I'm sorry, but no children *beneath* / *under* twelve are allowed.
c The noise was loud, so I put my hands *above* / *over* my ears.
d Are you going *at* / *to* the cinema this evening?
e There was a bird singing in the tree just *outside* / *out of* the window.
f David didn't feel well while he was *in* / *on* the ship.
g Get out *of* / *from* my house, or I'll call the police.
h Her left leg had to be cut off *above* / *over* the knee.
i David Bowie was born *at* / *in* London in 1947.
j Maria was walking *in* / *into* the garden picking flowers.

2 Rewrite each sentence so that it contains the word in capitals.

a Can you tell me whether Jim is at home? — IN
Can you tell me whether Jim is in?
b Mary has gone to live in a foreign country. — ABROAD
c Shall we go into the house now? — INDOORS
d This snake is red on the top but green on the bottom. — UNDERNEATH
e Don't come in, please. — OUTSIDE
f David has gone on a trip. — AWAY
g Alan lives on the other side of the road. — OPPOSITE
h Sorry, but Sue isn't here at the moment. — OUT

history

3 Complete the text with *in*, *at* and *on*.

Many archaeologists had searched for the tombs of Pharaohs a ___in___ the Valley of the Kings b _____ Egypt. Only Howard Carter believed he knew where the tomb might be. He had a map of the valley, and c _____ it he had marked all the excavations until he discovered a space. d _____ the ground there was a pile of stones and earth from earlier excavations. Some steps were uncovered, and e _____ the bottom of the steps was a door. f _____ the door was the symbol of Tutankhamun. Carter had to wait for Lord Carnarvon, who was g _____ home h _____ England, to arrive. Carnarvon was paying for the work. When he arrived i _____ the excavation, after digging some more, Carter and his workers broke through a door and found themselves j _____ the tomb. k _____ this point they thought they had failed, because the tomb was empty. Then they found another door, which led to an undisturbed room. There were many beautiful things l _____ this room, and wonderful paintings m _____ the walls. Most of the objects from the tomb are now displayed n _____ a local museum.

GLOSSARY

4 Complete the sentence with *in*, *at*, *on* or *to*.

a Columbus and his three ships started on the voyage ___to___ America in August 1492.
b They stopped first _____ one of the Canary Islands.
c On 12 October they came _____ the coast of the Bahamas.
d From there they went _____ Cuba, where one of the ships, the *Pinta*, left in search of gold _____ an island called 'Babeque'.
e Columbus continued with the other two ships and they came _____ Hispaniola on 5 December.
f Unfortunately, the flagship *Santa Maria* ran aground _____ a reef on Christmas Eve, and sank the next day.
g Columbus built a fort _____ the shore and left some of his men there, because there was not room for all the men _____ the tiny *Niña*, the other ship.
h While he was on his way back _____ Spain, Columbus found the *Pinta* again.
i The two ships left together, but were parted by a storm _____ the North Atlantic.
j Both ships arrived _____ Lisbon on 15 March within a few hours of each other.



5 Complete the sentence with a suitable preposition.

a The uvula is a small piece of flesh that hangs down ___at___ the back of your throat.
b The island of Alcatraz is _____ the middle of San Francisco Bay.
c Write your address _____ the top of the letter on the right-hand side.
d It was hard to watch the match because there were several tall people standing _____ front of me.
e _____ the end of the play, the whole audience burst into applause.
f The man was completely bald _____ the top of his head.
g Anna felt tired, so she stopped the car _____ the side of the road and got out.
h Divers cannot work _____ the bottom of the sea for very long.

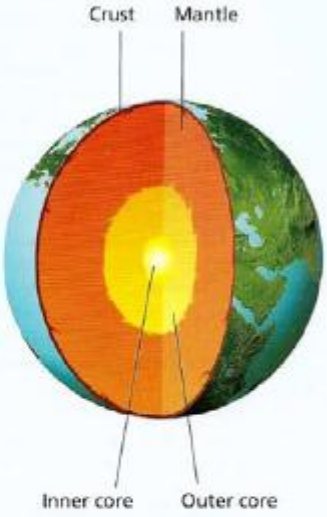
6 Choose the correct option, A, B, C or D, to complete the text.

We know that the inside of the Earth has a metallic core (or central part), a rocky mantle (or outer part), and a thin crust or surface. As a result of high pressure a ___B___ the core, it is hotter b _____ the centre of the Earth than it is c _____ the Sun. The mantle is a layer of dense rock that lies d _____ the surface and above the liquid core.

The crust is the thinnest layer, being only about 35 km deep e _____ continents, and f _____ the oceans it is even thinner – only 5 km. Because of the crust's low density the material floats g _____ the denser mantle. The crust is divided into sections called tectonic plates. The Earth as we now know it was formed in four different stages. First of all, the most dense material (eg iron) sank h _____ the centre of the planet. Lighter materials and gases stayed i _____ the surface and j _____ the atmosphere. The dense material formed the core of the Earth, and the lighter solids formed the crust. In the second stage, impacts from objects eg asteroids, comets, left the kind of crater marks we can still see k _____ the Moon.

During the third stage, lava came up l _____ the Earth's crust and rain began to fall m _____ the sky. The first heavy rains formed oceans and lakes.

The fourth stage is still going on now as the surface changes. Mountains are rising n _____ some areas. Large areas of solid material, tectonic plates, are moving just o _____ the surface.



a	A *to*	B *at*	C *from*	D *outside*		i	A *in*	B *to*	C *at*	D *from*	
b	A *to*	B *from*	C *under*	D *at*		j	A *at*	B *on*	C *under*	D *in*	
c	A *on*	B *under*	C *to*	D *from*		k	A *in*	B *on*	C *to*	D *from*	
d	A *into*	B *outside*	C *below*	D *on*		l	A *in*	B *from*	C *at*	D *outside*	
e	A *to*	B *at*	C *under*	D *in*		m	A *from*	B *to*	C *under*	D *in*	
f	A *under*	B *in*	C *on*	D *outside*		n	A *at*	B *to*	C *in*	D *on*	
g	A *on*	B *from*	C *under*	D *out of*		o	A *to*	B *from*	C *below*	D *in*	
h	A *at*	B *in*	C *on*	D *to*							

GLOSSARY